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Mid-Rise Condominium Development in the Philippines

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Abstract

This study examines mid-rise condominium developments in the Philippines, focusing on their architectural planning, community design, regulatory requirements, and contribution to sustainable urban development. As urban populations continue to grow and available land becomes increasingly limited, mid-rise condominiums provide an alternative housing strategy that accommodates higher residential density while maintaining a more human-scale environment compared to high-rise developments. The study reviews relevant literature on condominium typologies, community architecture, urban design, accessibility, sustainability, and passive design strategies. It also examines applicable Philippine regulations, including the National Building Code of the Philippines (PD 1096), the Subdivision and Condominium Buyers' Protective Decree (PD 957), Batas Pambansa Blg. 344, the Fire Code of the Philippines, and environmental and zoning requirements. Selected case studies, including Serin East Tagaytay, Solmera Coast, and Capri Oasis, are analyzed in terms of site context, planning strategies, building configuration, amenities, circulation, community spaces, and regulatory compliance. The findings indicate that successful mid-rise condominium developments require a balance between residential density, open spaces, accessibility, safety, environmental responsiveness, and opportunities for social interaction. The study further emphasizes that regulations should be integrated into the design process from the early planning stages to achieve functional, inclusive, and sustainable residential environments. Overall, mid-rise condominiums can contribute to community-oriented urban development when designed not only as efficient housing structures but as integrated communities that respond to their residents, surrounding context, and environmental conditions.

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II. Introduction

A. Background of the Study

A condominium development is a residential building comprising a number of privately owned units and common areas and amenities shared by the residents. Each unit is owned by a single person. The areas outside the private units are considered common property and are for collective use. Such common areas can include lobbies, hallways, recreation areas, swimming pools, landscaped areas, parking spaces, playgrounds, and other community facilities. Architecturally speaking, the proper design of a condominium is about finding a balance between private living spaces and common areas. The design needs to consider circulation, accessibility, ventilation, privacy, spatial organization, and communal facilities to create a comfortable living environment while fostering interaction and a sense of community among residents (Asia & Asia, 2023).

Mid-rise condominiums are generally characterized by buildings ranging from approximately four to twelve storeys, often incorporating dedicated or separate parking facilities, like any other buildings. Compared with low-rise developments, mid-rise condominiums typically accommodate more residential units while maintaining a moderate building scale. In terms of location, mid-rise developments are often situated in urban areas but outside the most densely developed and highly congested districts. This allows them to provide residents with accessibility to urban services and facilities while offering a comparatively less intensive residential environment than high-rise condominium developments. Consequently, mid-rise

condominiums are generally positioned as a balance between the lower density of low-rise developments and the greater scale and density associated with high-rise buildings.

Mid-rise condominium developments serve as an intermediate form of residential development between high-density high-rise buildings and low-density single-family housing. This makes mid-rise housing an important component of sustainable urban development, particularly in areas experiencing increasing demand for residential space. From an urban housing perspective, mid-rise condominiums increase housing capacity by accommodating more residents on a relatively limited land area. Compared with high-rise developments, they generally require less complex structural systems and construction methods, potentially resulting in lower development and maintenance costs. Their moderate scale also allows for more efficient land utilization without creating the intense vertical density commonly associated with skyscrapers. Mid-rise condominiums also contribute to community development by supporting walkable and connected neighborhoods. The concentration of residents can increase pedestrian activity and support nearby commercial establishments, public services, and community facilities. Within the development itself, shared amenities can encourage social interaction among residents and strengthen the sense of community (Centre for Cities, 2025).

Furthermore, the relatively moderate height of mid-rise buildings can help preserve the existing character and visual scale of established neighborhoods. When appropriately integrated with surrounding buildings, streetscapes, and open spaces, mid-rise condominiums can provide additional housing while maintaining a balanced relationship between built density, pedestrian experience, and community-oriented open spaces. Thus, mid-rise condominium development represents a practical approach to addressing urban housing demand while promoting efficient

land use, walkability, and sustainable community growth.

B. Statement of the Problem

This study aims to examine the planning and design considerations for the development of mid-rise condominiums, particularly in relation to rising urban housing demand. Specifically, it seeks to answer the following questions:

1. What are the major planning and architectural challenges encountered in the development of mid-rise condominiums in the Philippines?
2. How can architectural planning and design strategies effectively address issues of residential density, livability, and sustainability in mid-rise condominium buildings in the Philippines?
3. How can the integration of open spaces, green spaces, communal facilities, and efficient circulation contribute to the overall quality of the residential environment and community connection?
4. What design strategies can be applied to balance efficient land use with residents' needs for privacy, comfort, accessibility, proper ventilation, and community interaction?
5. How can mid-rise condominium developments help address the housing shortage in the Philippines by providing affordable, accessible, and sustainable residential options through efficient land use?

C. Objectives of the Study

- To analyze the planning and design principles applicable to mid-rise condominium developments.
- To evaluate the regulatory frameworks governing mid-rise condominium development in the Philippines.
- To identify best practices for community-oriented and sustainable residential design that works in a tropical country.
- To assess the potential of mid-rise condominium developments to help address the housing shortage in the Philippines through efficient land use and increased residential capacity.

D. Scope and Limitations

This study focuses on mid-rise residential condominium developments within the Philippine context, with particular emphasis on community-oriented architecture and urban design considerations. It examines planning and design strategies that address residential density, livability, sustainability, efficient land use, and the provision of shared spaces and amenities. The study also considers the potential role of mid-rise condominiums in addressing the housing shortage in the Philippines. However, the research is primarily limited to architectural and urban planning perspectives and does not extensively cover detailed financial, structural, or construction management aspects of mid-rise condominium development.

E. Significance of the Study

The architects, engineers, and consumers who are involved in the construction and use of mid-rise condominium housing in the Philippines can benefit from this study's pertinent insights.

For condominium developers, the findings may serve as a guide in formulating planning and design approaches that promote efficient land utilization, functionality, sustainability, and resident well-being. For unit buyers and investors, the study may provide a better understanding of the design, accessibility, comfort, and overall value of mid-rise condominium developments.

For regulatory agencies, the study may provide useful information to evaluate existing planning standards and guidelines for residential condominium development. For architecture students and professionals, it may serve as a reference for understanding community-oriented residential design, urban integration, and sustainable architectural practices.

Moreover, the study aims to contribute to improving urban housing solutions by exploring how mid-rise condominiums can accommodate more residents while maintaining a livable, community-oriented environment. It also highlights the importance of sustainable and inclusive design through appropriate open spaces, shared facilities, accessibility, and efficient site planning. The findings may also further benefit other stakeholders, including urban planners, housing organizations, local communities, and policymakers, in developing responsive strategies to meet the Philippines' growing housing needs.

III. Review of Related Literature (RRL)

A. Definition and Typologies of Mid-Rise Condominium

1. Low-Rise Condominiums

Low-rise condominiums are residential developments generally composed of one to four storeys, characterized by a predominantly horizontal building form and a relatively low-density layout. These developments commonly incorporate landscaped areas, spacious communal spaces, and outdoor environments that strengthen residents' connection to nature. Their limited building height creates a quieter and more relaxed atmosphere, making them suitable for families and individuals seeking a less dense residential setting.

The smaller scale of low-rise condominiums can also foster a stronger sense of community by allowing residents to interact more easily within shared spaces. Compared with high-rise developments, simpler building configurations can result in lower construction and operational costs. They also tend to require less complex maintenance due to fewer building systems and shared facilities. Overall, low-rise condominiums provide a balance of affordability, accessibility to open spaces, and community interaction while maintaining a more intimate residential environment (Land, 2025).



Figure 1. Low-rise condominium of Avida in Makati City.

2. Mid-Rise Condominiums

Mid-rise condominiums serve as a transitional form of residential development between low-rise housing and high-rise towers. Generally consisting of five to twelve storeys, these developments provide greater vertical density than low-rise buildings while maintaining a more moderate scale than skyscrapers. This makes them suitable for residents seeking the benefits of condominium living, such as improved views, accessibility, and shared amenities, without the higher costs and intensity typically associated with high-rise developments.

Architecturally speaking, mid-rise condominiums provide a balance between residential density and livability. Their moderate height allows for the incorporation of courtyards, landscaped areas, and communal spaces that encourage interaction among residents while avoiding the highly concentrated character of high-rise buildings. They can also enable more efficient land use and greater residential capacity while maintaining access to urban services and amenities. Overall, mid-rise condominiums offer a practical housing typology that combines urban accessibility, efficient spatial planning, and a more community-oriented residential environment. A mid-rise condominium is a multi-family residential or mixed-use development that typically ranges from approximately four to twelve storeys in height. It is typically equipped with vertical circulation systems, such as elevators and stairways, to accommodate residents and users across multiple levels (Land, 2025).



Figure 2. Mid-rise condominium of Ivory Wood, Taguig.

3. High-rise Condominiums

High-rise condominiums represent a highly vertical form of residential development, characterized by tall buildings that accommodate a large number of residential units within a limited land area. These developments are commonly located in dense urban areas where residents can easily access commercial establishments, schools, transportation hubs, restaurants, and other essential services. Their elevated locations often provide panoramic views of the surrounding city, while their modern architectural designs and range of amenities make them attractive to residents seeking a convenient and urban-oriented lifestyle.

High-rise condominiums can also be considered an appealing investment option, particularly in areas with strong demand for residential properties. Their strategic locations and proximity to various urban facilities can contribute to their market value and accessibility. In terms of security, many high-rise developments provide controlled access, security personnel, and surveillance systems to ensure the safety of residents. In addition, these developments often offer amenities and flexible payment schemes, making condominium ownership more accessible

to potential buyers. Overall, high-rise condominiums provide a combination of vertical living, urban convenience, security, and access to various facilities, although they generally involve greater density and a more intensive use of vertical space compared with low- and mid-rise developments.



Figure 3. High-rise condominium of One Rockwell East Tower, Metro Manila.

Circling back, as an intermediate building typology, mid-rise condominiums provide a balance between the high density and verticality of high-rise developments and the lower density and more open character of low-rise housing. These developments are commonly located in urban fringe areas, secondary commercial districts, and accessible suburban areas where they can provide increased residential capacity while maintaining a relatively moderate building scale. Compared with high-rise developments, mid-rise condominiums generally accommodate a lower population density, which can contribute to a less congested residential environment and encourage stronger community interaction among residents (Asia & Asia, 2023).

Mid-rise condominiums may be classified into different typologies based on their primary function, spatial organization, and relationship to their surrounding environment. Purely residential mid-rise condominiums are developments primarily dedicated to housing, offering

various unit types ranging from studio apartments to larger multi-bedroom units. Mixed-use mid-rise developments, on the other hand, integrate residential spaces with commercial functions, commonly providing retail establishments, convenience stores, cafés, or other services on the lower levels while residential units occupy the upper floors.

Another typology is the courtyard or perimeter-style condominium, in which residential buildings are organized around a central shared open space, such as a garden, landscaped courtyard, or recreational area. This arrangement promotes access to communal spaces, natural light, ventilation, and social interaction among residents. Suburban walk-up and urban infill developments are also common forms of mid-rise housing, characterized by compact building configurations designed to maximize available land while responding to local zoning regulations and surrounding urban conditions. These developments are particularly suitable for areas where high-rise construction is restricted, as they can increase residential density while maintaining an appropriate building scale, visual character, and access to natural light (*Low Rise Condos Vs. Mid-Rise Vs. High-Rise: What's Best for You?*, 2026).

B. Principles of Community Architecture

The goal of community architecture in mid-rise condominium developments is to create living spaces that are cozy, reachable, and integrated with their surroundings. In order to promote interaction and a stronger sense of community, these principles place a strong emphasis on human-scale design, shared spaces, universal accessibility, and the incorporation of greenery. Community-oriented architecture seeks to create a balance between welcoming communal areas and private residential spaces, as opposed to creating an atmosphere that feels overly dense or isolated (Huggins, 2025).

In mid-rise condominiums, human-scale design is crucial because it makes the structure feel more approachable and connected to its occupants. Compared to high-rise towers, a building height of roughly five to twelve stories can offer adequate residential capacity while preserving a more manageable relationship with the ground level. Warm materials, stepped setbacks, balconies, and a variety of façade treatments are architectural features that can lessen a large building mass's apparent weight. In addition, landscaped buffers, pedestrian-friendly entrances, and open or semi-open edges can be used in place of strong, imposing boundaries in ground-level areas. This human connection can be further strengthened by greenery, especially when trees and planted areas are visible from several floors. This strategy can be seen in some developments, like DMCI Homes, where landscaped areas and mature trees are incorporated into the development and are visible to residents even from higher floors. This contributes to a more pleasant residential environment and strengthens the visual connection between the building, landscape, and community.

Community architecture places a strong emphasis on social interaction, especially in condominium complexes where residents share common areas and amenities. Residents have areas to congregate, unwind, and socialize thanks to the addition of central courtyards, outdoor atriums, pocket parks, swimming pools, playgrounds, and landscaped gardens. These areas can act as hubs for the residential community, promoting social interaction and fostering stronger bonds. Clubhouses, swimming pools, recreational areas, and common rooftop spaces should be positioned strategically along major circulation routes to promote casual interactions between residents as they move through the development. Furthermore, the placement of windows, balconies, and building entrances with views of common areas, walkways, and playgrounds can offer natural surveillance. This idea, which is sometimes referred to as "eyes on the street,"

increases residents' sense of security by enabling them to naturally observe activities taking place in common areas. Condominium design can encourage social interaction and a greater sense of community security thru the strategic placement and visibility of common areas (DMCI Homes | Real Estate Philippines, Condo, House &Amp; Lot for Sale, 2016).

In order to ensure that people of various ages and physical abilities can use the development comfortably, accessibility and inclusivity are fundamental concepts in community-oriented condominium design. Accessible entrances, wide elevators, barrier-free walkways, ramps, and tactile pavement can all make moving around the building safer and easier. In order to enable them to participate equally in the community, shared facilities should also be designed to accommodate various user groups, such as young families, working residents, older adults, and people with disabilities. The cognitive and sensory requirements of residents should be taken into account in inclusive design. People with sensory sensitivity or other needs may find it easier to navigate and more comfortable in an environment with clear and consistent wayfinding, sufficient but low-glare lighting, appropriate signage, and quiet areas. Mid-rise condominiums can provide a more accessible, friendly, and inclusive setting for a diverse residential community by taking these factors into account during the planning and design phase (“Community Building and Placemaking Report,” 2021).

In community-oriented condominium design, environmental integration and adaptability are also key concepts. Mature trees, green walls, landscaped areas, and natural ventilation are examples of biophilic features that can be added to a development to improve air circulation, lower temperatures, and make it more comfortable for occupants. Additionally, by strengthening the residents' bond with nature, these features can enhance their general comfort and wellbeing. By enabling shared spaces to be used for various purposes throughout the day, flexible spaces

can enhance their functionality even more. For instance, a multipurpose space could serve as a co-working space during the day and be transformed into a venue for meetings, community events, or leisure activities at night. Parking and vehicle circulation can be positioned underground or along the development's periphery to achieve a pedestrian-priority approach at the site level. In addition to giving residents more chances to walk, socialize, and utilize landscaped open spaces, this contributes to the creation of safer and quieter interior pathways (Dan & Dan, 2025).

C. Urban Design Considerations

Finding a balance between increased residential density and a comfortable living environment is a key component of urban design for mid-rise condominiums. Compact and well-connected neighborhoods can be supported by mid-rise developments without sacrificing livability through effective land use, dynamic streetscapes, and integration with public transportation. The Floor Area Ratio (FAR), which helps regulate the overall building bulk and permits the site to accommodate more residential units while maintaining an appropriate building scale, is one crucial factor. Without reaching the intensity of high-rise towers, mid-rise developments, which are usually between five and twelve stories high, can effectively utilize urban land. By putting retail stores, cafes, convenience stores, and other community services on the ground floor, mixed-use integration can further enhance the development's functionality. These areas can benefit locals as well as the neighborhood while making the streets more pedestrian-friendly and active. Additionally, the development's overall environmental quality can be enhanced by setting aside a sizable portion of the site for courtyards, green areas, and public plazas rather than heavily depending on surface parking. This strategy contributes to a more

sustainable and livable urban environment while giving locals chances for leisure and social interaction (Larrea, 2023).

In order to create a more accessible and pedestrian-friendly environment, walkability and connectivity are crucial factors in the urban design of mid-rise condominiums. Using lower building façades with a variety of textures, active frontages, and transparent materials like glass to create visual interest and a more welcoming experience for pedestrians is one way to achieve human-scale design. Pedestrian walkways should be broad, well-lit, shaded, and free of impediments like utility poles, parked cars, and needless barriers at the site level. Residents are encouraged to move around the development on foot and engage with their surroundings when there are comfortable walking routes. Because it makes it easier for people to move through and around the development, porosity also contributes significantly to increased connectivity. Direct routes between residential areas, commercial spaces, streets, and shared facilities can be established through permeable site edges, multiple entrances, and mid-block pedestrian connections. Mid-rise condominium developments can enhance their integration with the surrounding neighborhoods and foster a more vibrant and cohesive community by giving pedestrians priority and upholding clear connections throughout the site (October, 2023).

When designing mid-rise condominiums, transit-oriented development (TOD) is crucial, especially in cities where having access to public transportation can lessen reliance on private automobiles. By offering safe bicycle parking, covered waiting areas, and real-time public transportation information in easily accessible locations like the lobby, developments can support this strategy. These amenities can encourage locals to select alternate forms of transportation and make public and active transportation more convenient. Additionally, mid-rise condominiums can be positioned so that they are 400–800 meters away on foot from important transportation

hubs like bus stops and train stations. Residential developments are better connected to work centers, educational institutions, business districts, and other vital services when they are situated within a comfortable walking distance of public transportation. Reducing the amount of parking available can promote the use of public transportation even more while freeing up more space for communal areas, landscaping, and pedestrian areas. In general, incorporating TOD principles can aid in the development of residential communities that are more accessible, connected, and land-efficient (Archifynow, 2026).

Adaptive reuse, effective waste and utility management, and microclimate-responsive planning are additional crucial factors in mid-rise condominium design. Designing ground-floor areas and structural grids with sufficient flexibility to allow for future changes in function, such as transforming retail spaces into offices, clinics, or other community-oriented uses, can support adaptive reuse. This enables the development to change over time to meet evolving needs without necessitating significant structural adjustments. Through centralized, well-organized, and covert disposal systems, proper waste and utility management should also be integrated into the design. In addition to improving overall site management, placing utility and garbage collection areas away from main residential and communal areas can help maintain cleanliness and lessen offensive odors. Additionally, buildings should be carefully oriented to maximize natural ventilation and prevailing winds while minimizing exposure to strong afternoon sunlight in order to take into account microclimate design. Buildings, openings, landscaping, and shading devices can all be placed strategically to enhance thermal comfort and produce a more energy-efficient living space (Steuteville, 2021).

D. Site Planning for Mid-Rise Developments

A well-designed mid-rise condominium site should strike a balance between resident comfort, safety, and effective space utilization. In addition to providing enough green space and common areas, the site plan should arrange parking and circulation so that residents, guests, and service vehicles can move around effectively. Routes for cars and pedestrians should be clearly marked off to increase safety and make daily activities more comfortable. For emergency and fire truck access to be unhindered throughout the development, pedestrian and vehicular circulation should be carefully planned. Main drop-off locations should be placed close to the building lobby so that residents, guests, and people with mobility issues can easily access them. Clearly marked and visible crosswalks, suitable signage, sufficient lighting, and secure connections between buildings, parking lots, entrances, and shared facilities should all be features of pedestrian routes. These tactics prioritize convenience and safety while assisting in the creation of a more accessible and orderly condominium environment (Global Designing Cities Initiative, 2022).

A welcoming and community-focused mid-rise condominium setting is largely dependent on open areas and shared amenities. In order to give residents opportunities for leisure, recreation, and social interaction, a portion of the property may be devoted to communal areas, recreational facilities, and landscaped open spaces. To reduce noise and create a more tranquil atmosphere, facilities like clubhouses and swimming pools should be placed away from busy entrances and major roads. The quality and usability of outdoor spaces can be further enhanced by additional features like playgrounds, pocket gardens, seating areas, and shaded walkways. In addition to reducing heat within the development, trees and other landscaping elements can offer shade along pedestrian pathways. A healthier, more comfortable, and socially cohesive

residential community can be supported by the site through the strategic placement and integration of open spaces and amenities (Respicio, 2025).

In mid-rise condominium developments, efficient parking planning is crucial to maximizing land use while preserving visitor and resident convenience and safety. Vehicles can be parked in basements or podiums, freeing up more ground-level space for common areas, landscaping, and pedestrian zones. In order to protect guests from the sun and rain, covered parking spaces may also be offered. Bicycle and electric vehicle spaces can be added to parking lots to encourage more environmentally friendly forms of transportation. In order to maintain efficient traffic flow and avoid congestion, especially during peak hours, clear and well-organized entry and exit points are also essential. In general, an effective parking plan should strike a balance between the requirement for vehicle access and the objective of developing a residential area that is both pedestrian-friendly and community-focused (InnoDez Design & Engineering Services, 2025).

Waste management, outdoor lighting, building orientation, and utility organization are additional planning factors for mid-rise condominiums. To preserve cleanliness and avoid detracting from the aesthetics and comfort of residential and communal spaces, waste disposal areas should be situated in hidden but easily accessible service zones. To enhance visibility and encourage safety at night, adequate outdoor lighting should be installed along walkways, entrances, parking lots, and common areas. Building orientation should minimize exposure to the sun's intense heat while maximizing natural ventilation and prevailing winds. This can lessen reliance on mechanical cooling and enhance thermal comfort. In order to improve the efficiency of inspection, maintenance, and repairs, utility lines and service systems should also be

appropriately grouped and arranged in easily accessible locations. These factors help create a condominium environment that is safer, cozier, and better run.

E. Building Design Considerations

When designing mid-rise condominiums, comfort, security, and effective use of space are crucial factors to take into account. While giving residents comfortable and useful living spaces, efficient unit layouts can make the most of the available floor area. While placing kitchens and bathrooms close to the building's service cores can simplify plumbing systems and possibly lower construction costs, open-plan layouts can help smaller units feel more roomy. Simple rectangular room layouts allow for flexibility in furniture placement, and built-in storage can help reduce clutter and maximize available space.

To create a comfortable and healthy indoor environment, unit design should include sufficient natural lighting and ventilation in addition to space efficiency. Windows and other openings should be positioned appropriately to preserve privacy while allowing light and ventilation. Controlled access, sensible door and window placement, and a distinct division between private and public spaces can all improve security. Condominium unit planning can produce residential areas that are practical, cozy, private, and safe for daily use by taking these aspects into consideration (Interior, 2026).

For condominiums to be both comfortable and energy-efficient, natural lighting and ventilation are crucial. By allowing warm air to escape and fresh air to enter, dual-aspect units—which have openings on two different sides—can encourage cross-ventilation. Natural ventilation can also be incorporated into shared areas and corridors, especially if they are open or partially open to the outside. By increasing the amount of daylight that enters the units, wide

windows and well-designed ceiling heights can lessen the need for artificial lighting during the day. To control solar heat gain, windows' orientation should also be carefully taken into account. While excessive exposure to the west should be controlled due to the stronger afternoon sun, openings facing east and north can typically offer more comfortable daylight conditions. Mid-rise condominiums can improve indoor comfort while lowering reliance on artificial lighting and mechanical cooling through appropriate building orientation, window placement, ventilation techniques, and shading devices (Samara & Samara, 2025).

When designing common areas and mid-rise condominium units, privacy and security should be carefully taken into account. One way to lessen crowding, noise, and needless foot traffic in residential corridors is to limit the number of residential units on each floor. In addition to reducing noise transmission, sound-insulating walls between adjacent apartments can increase residents' comfort and privacy. CCTV cameras at building entrances and other key locations, smart locks, and controlled access points are some ways to improve security. Furthermore, it is easier to manage movement within the development and avoid needless access to residential areas when public areas and private residential zones are clearly marked off. These tactics preserve easy access to common areas while fostering a more secure and private living environment (925R Design Inc, 2026).

Covered parking, accessible vertical circulation, green elements, and energy-efficient systems are additional building design factors for mid-rise condominiums. In addition to increasing convenience and comfort, covered parking can shield tenants and visitors from inclement weather. To guarantee simple and barrier-free access for locals, guests, senior citizens, and people with disabilities, ramps and elevators should also be included. To add greenery and enhance the general residential environment, the development can incorporate green roofs,

landscaped areas, and small pocket gardens. In addition to offering chances for rest, these areas can aid in lowering the building's temperature. To further cut down on energy use and operating expenses, energy-efficient lighting should be installed in common areas like parking lots, lobbies, hallways, and stairwells. When combined, these tactics can help create a condominium development that is more comfortable, sustainable, and accessible (Gatewise, 2024).

F. Sustainability and Environmental Design

In addition to lowering utility costs, passive design techniques can enhance a mid-rise condominium's thermal efficiency, comfort, and safety. By placing windows and other openings on opposing or adjacent sides of a unit, you can achieve cross ventilation, which lets air flow through the space naturally. Overhangs, ledges, and louvers are examples of sun-shading elements that can lower direct solar heat and keep interior spaces cooler, especially during periods of intense sunlight. Another crucial factor is building orientation, where the longer sides of the structure are typically oriented along the north-south axis to reduce exposure to direct sunlight from the east and west. Additionally, having windows that are the right size can optimize natural light and lessen the need for artificial lighting during the day. Combining these passive techniques can increase indoor comfort, lessen reliance on mechanical systems, and help create a condominium development that is more sustainable and energy-efficient (Shererarch, 2025).

While lessening their negative effects on the environment, green building techniques can enhance mid-rise condominium developments' comfort and environmental performance. These methods include using low-toxicity, locally sourced, and recycled materials, which can lessen the negative effects of transportation, waste, and possible health hazards related to hazardous

materials. The building's long-term sustainability and efficiency can also be enhanced by the choice of robust and ecologically friendly materials. Green roofs can enhance a building's thermal performance by lowering heat absorption through the use of grass, shrubs, or small trees. In a similar vein, additional shade and a reduction in heat gain can be achieved by adding vertical vegetation or green walls to otherwise unutilized exterior surfaces. The building envelope's capacity to sustain comfortable interior temperatures can also be enhanced by carefully chosen wall, roof, and insulation materials. When combined, these tactics can promote sustainable building practices and make residential spaces cooler, healthier, and more ecologically conscious (*Eco-Friendly Homes: Sustainable Living & Design Tips | EcoFlow US*, 2026).

In mid-rise condominium developments, energy-efficient systems can lower operating expenses and electricity consumption. Because LED lighting uses less energy and typically has a longer service life than conventional lighting, it can be used in common areas, hallways, stairwells, and other shared spaces. In order to produce renewable energy that can power outdoor lighting and other specific building systems, solar panels can also be installed on accessible roof areas. By modifying energy use based on demand, the use of energy-efficient inverter elevators can further lower electricity consumption. Additionally, spaces with sporadic occupancy can be equipped with motion-activated lighting and smart sensors, which enable lights to turn off automatically when spaces are empty. These tactics can lower operating costs, promote more environmentally friendly condominium development, and enhance the building's overall energy performance (Properties, n.d.).

In order to encourage water efficiency and lessen the environmental impact of mid-rise condominium developments, water management systems are crucial. Rainwater harvesting systems are capable of gathering and storing rainwater for non-potable applications like cleaning

outdoor or public spaces and landscape irrigation. In order to lessen the need for fresh water, greywater recycling systems can also repurpose slightly contaminated water from sinks and showers for tasks like flushing toilets. Water consumption can be further decreased without appreciably compromising user comfort by using low-flow fixtures, such as water-efficient showerheads, toilets, and faucets. Permeable pavement can help lower surface runoff and promote natural groundwater recharge in outdoor spaces by allowing rainwater to seep into the ground rather than instantly entering drainage systems. When combined, these tactics can increase water efficiency and support the development of more sustainable condominiums (*Water Conservation Measures: Sustainable Practices in Real Estate - MIPIM World Blog*, 2024).

Mid-rise condominium developments can include additional sustainable elements to promote eco-friendly behavior among occupants. To encourage the use of electric vehicles and lessen reliance on traditional fuel-powered transportation, parking lots can be equipped with EV charging stations. To make it simpler for locals to separate recyclable, biodegradable, and residual waste, waste segregation areas should also be easily accessible and well-organized. Another useful tactic is the use of native landscaping, which enhances the site's ecological character while typically requiring less water and upkeep thanks to locally adapted trees and plants. Additionally, by making bicycle racks safe and easily accessible, locals can be encouraged to use their bikes for short trips, which will lessen their dependency on private vehicles. When combined, these elements can encourage more environmentally friendly landscaping, resource management, and transportation within the condominium community (Hutter, 2024).

G. Economic and Social Impacts

Mid-rise condominiums can offer a more economical and effective housing option while preserving a cozy, neighborhood-focused setting when compared to high-rise condominiums and low-density residential subdivisions. Without the increased construction complexity usually associated with tall buildings, their moderate building height enables more effective land use. For households looking for accessible urban housing, mid-rise developments can offer a balance between residential density and a human-scale living environment. Because they typically require less complex structural systems, fewer high-capacity elevators, and fewer expensive building amenities than high-rise developments, mid-rise condominiums may have lower initial development and construction costs. However, growing land values, building costs, and housing demand in large cities like Metro Manila continue to make affordability a problem. Even tho mid-rise buildings have comparatively lower development costs, these market forces have the potential to raise unit prices. Therefore, to optimize the potential of mid-rise condominiums as an affordable housing option, careful planning and effective use of land and resources are required (*Comparing Low Rise, Mid Rise and High Rise Buildings: A Renter's Guide | Swiftlane*, 2023).

Compared to large high-rise developments, mid-rise condominiums offer a more human-scale and less crowded residential environment, which can strengthen community formation. Because of their smaller number of units and moderate height, residents may have more opportunities to get to know and engage with their neighbors. This may contribute to the development's increased sense of community and belonging. Incorporating communal areas like courtyards, pocket gardens, playgrounds, lounges, and multipurpose halls can promote social engagement among inhabitants. These areas offer chances for casual interactions, neighborhood events, and get-togethers between various groups, such as families, young professionals, and

senior citizens. Mid-rise condominiums can foster social relationships while preserving a comfortable balance between private and shared living areas by carefully designing common areas (*Client Challenge*, n.d.).

By concentrating more housing within already-existing urban and semi-urban areas, mid-rise condominiums can aid in the reduction of urban sprawl. The need to expand infrastructure into undeveloped areas can be decreased by building residential areas in places that already have access to utilities, roads, public transportation, and other services. This can assist in reducing the financial and ecological expenses related to growing transportation and utility networks. By expanding housing capacity without requiring sizable land areas, mid-rise developments also promote compact urban growth. By avoiding the large land consumption associated with sprawling subdivisions, their moderate building height enables more residents to be accommodated on comparatively small parcels. Mid-rise condominiums can support more efficient growth patterns while protecting agricultural land, open spaces, and other undeveloped areas at the urban periphery by focusing development on already serviced areas (*Client Challenge*, n.d.).

IV. Laws and Regulations on Condominium Development in the Philippines

A. Republic Act No. 4726 (The Condominium Act)

The legal foundation for condominium ownership and development in the Philippines was established by the Condominium Act, also known as Republic Act No. 4726, which was passed on June 18, 1966. Individual ownership of a particular unit and an undivided interest in the land and common areas shared with other unit owners are the two types of interests that

constitute condominium ownership under the Act. The fundamental rules for the creation, management, and administration of condominium developments are also established by the law (*Republic Act No. 4726*, n.d.).

Owning a condominium entails having both a shared interest in the development's common areas and exclusive ownership of a single unit. Any sale, transfer, or encumbrance of a condominium unit includes the owner's related interest in the common areas since the ownership of a unit cannot be divorced from its corresponding share in the common property. The exclusive ownership of a particular area within the building, like an office, room, or apartment, is referred to as the separate interest. The proportionate share of ownership in the land and common areas, such as the building's foundations, external walls, roofs, lobbies, and other amenities shared by the unit owners, is referred to as the undivided interest (*Client Challenge*, n.d.-b)

Under the Condominium Act, a condominium corporation may be established to hold ownership of the common areas and oversee the administration and management of the property. A condominium project is formally established through the registration of an enabling or master deed with the local Register of Deeds, which is also annotated on the corresponding land title. The master deed and declaration of restrictions establish the rules and conditions governing the development, including the use of units and common areas, building regulations, maintenance responsibilities, and assessment of shared expenses. Upon purchasing a condominium unit, owners automatically become members or shareholders of the condominium corporation and are therefore involved in the collective ownership and management of the common areas (Admin, 2020).

B. Presidential Decree No. 957 (Subdivision and Condominium Buyers' Protective Decree)

Property buyers in the Philippines are protected under the Subdivision and Condominium Buyers' Protective Decree (Presidential Decree No. 957), which aims to prevent fraudulent transactions, misleading claims, and the non-completion or improper delivery of real estate projects. The decree requires developers to secure the necessary licenses and permits and comply with established standards before offering subdivision lots or condominium units for sale. It also provides legal safeguards for buyers when developers fail to fulfill their responsibilities, particularly regarding the completion, delivery, and proper development of the project (*P.D. No. 957 – Legal (FAQs)*, n.d.).

The Department of Human Settlements and Urban Development (DHSUD) is the government agency responsible for overseeing the housing and real estate sector in the Philippines. It regulates developers and monitors their compliance with applicable housing regulations, including the registration and licensing of condominium and subdivision projects. Through these regulatory functions, the government seeks to promote fair and transparent property transactions, safeguard buyers' rights, and ensure that residential developments comply with appropriate standards for safety, quality, and development (*P.D. No. 957 – Legal (FAQs)*, n.d.).

The Subdivision and Condominium Buyers' Protective Decree (Presidential Decree No. 957) offers a number of safeguards against potential issues that may arise during the acquisition and construction of condominium projects. Before marketing or selling condominium units, developers must obtain a current License to Sell, confirming that the project has complied with all applicable regulations. The matching title should be delivered free of liens and encumbrances after the buyer has paid the full purchase price, indicating that the unit is clearly owned. When developers neglect their obligations, the law offers remedies as well. Buyers may be able to halt

payments without incurring penalties if a project is not developed in accordance with its approved plans and standards. Subject to the terms and procedures stipulated by law, buyers may also request reimbursement of their payments, including any applicable interest, if the developer fails to construct or finish the necessary facilities and infrastructure. These clauses aid in ensuring that developers continue to be responsible for completing the project as promised to purchasers (*P.D. No. 957 – Legal (FAQs)*, n.d.).

Developers must fulfill a number of obligations under Presidential Decree No. 957 to guarantee that condominium projects are appropriately designed, authorized, and delivered to purchasers. Before moving forward with development and sales, developers must register their projects and obtain the required government approvals for subdivision or condominium plans. Without the proper government approval and, if necessary, the buyers' consent, no modifications should be made to the approved plans, specifications, or features. This makes it easier to guarantee that the completed project is in line with the initial proposal and approval. Until the title is formally transferred to the buyer in accordance with applicable regulations, developers are also in charge of real estate taxes and assessments on the property. Additionally, in order to guarantee the completion of the infrastructure, facilities, and amenities needed for the project, developers might be obliged to offer a performance bond or other financial guarantee. These obligations encourage responsibility and shield purchasers from unapproved modifications, delays, and unfinished development (*P.D. No. 957 – Legal (FAQs)*, n.d.).

To uphold the general well-being and requirements of the inhabitants, it is imperative that developers incorporate adequate shared facilities and open areas within residential projects. For subdivisions exceeding one hectare, a specific allocation of the land must be dedicated to playgrounds, parks, and communal infrastructure, with the required proportion determined by the

total gross area of the site. Such strategic planning facilitates social engagement, recreational activities, and various neighborhood gatherings, thereby strengthening the residential environment.

Additionally, roads, alleys, sidewalks, and designated open spaces must be appropriately constructed and, if necessary, set aside for public use. The developer shouldn't sell these areas privately or alter them in a way that isn't consistent with their authorized use. Until it is formally transferred to the relevant local government unit or homeowners' association, developers are also in charge of building and maintaining vital community infrastructure, such as roads, drainage systems, and water facilities. These regulations aid in ensuring that residential developments offer shared areas and the fundamental infrastructure required for a livable and functional community in addition to housing units (*P.D. No. 957 – Legal (FAQs)*, n.d.).

C. DHSUD / HLURB Guidelines

Mid-rise condominium developments in the Philippines are governed by a number of laws and regulations, most notably Presidential Decree No. 957 (PD 957) and the National Building Code of the Philippines (PD 1096), which are overseen by the Department of Human Settlements and Urban Development (DHSUD), formerly the Housing and Land Use Regulatory Board (HLURB) (*What Are the Obligations of the Owner or Developer of Subdivision Projects When It Comes to Open Spaces?*, 2023).

Before marketing or selling condominium units to the general public, one of the most important prerequisites for developers is obtaining a License to Sell (LS). This requirement aids in ensuring that the developer has adhered to the necessary documentation, approvals, and

development standards and that the project has undergone the required evaluation. Additionally, developers must adhere to all applicable regulations concerning community facilities, utilities, parking, open spaces, building density, site planning, and circulation. These regulations aid in preventing overdevelopment and guarantee that there is enough room for residents' mobility, leisure, safety, and general well-being. Furthermore, technical requirements for building safety, occupancy, fire protection, accessibility, light and ventilation, structural design, and other aspects of building construction are established by the National Building Code (PD 1096) and its implementing regulations. When taken as a whole, these rules offer a framework for striking a balance between residents' safety, comfort, and livability and the effective use of land. Because increased residential density must be supported by sufficient infrastructure, open spaces, circulation systems, and essential facilities, adherence to these standards is especially crucial for mid-rise condominiums (*What Are the Obligations of the Owner or Developer of Subdivision Projects When It Comes to Open Spaces?*, 2023).

As for the planning guidelines, in the Philippines, mid-rise condominium developments must adhere to planning regulations that guarantee the project is compatible with its site, the neighborhood, and the infrastructure already in place. While assisting in maintaining a balance between residential density and the standard of living, these standards direct development with regard to land use, building scale, access, utilities, and safety. Zoning Adherence. Condominium developments must abide by the local government unit's (LGU) zoning regulations and the relevant Comprehensive Land Use Plan (CLUP). The zoning classification of the property should be in line with the proposed land use, building height, density, setbacks, and other site requirements. In order to guarantee that the development is suitable for its surroundings and does not interfere with adjacent residential, commercial, institutional, or other land uses, local zoning

regulations must be followed (*HLURB ADMINISTRATIVE ORDER NO. 03, S. 1996, March 05, 1996*, n.d.).

The overall size and shape of the condominium development are restricted by planning regulations. The Floor Area Ratio (FAR), maximum building height, setbacks, and necessary road right-of-way (RROW) access are a few examples of these. These controls aid in limiting the amount of development that can be built on a site while preserving sufficient room for open spaces, natural lighting, ventilation, circulation, and emergency access. Controlling the building envelope is especially crucial for mid-rise condominiums in order to strike a balance between effective land use and a cozy human-scale setting. Structural, electrical, sanitary, water supply, drainage, and other utility systems must be appropriately planned and compliant in condominium developments. To guarantee dependable operation and occupant safety, these systems should be designed in accordance with relevant building and engineering standards. Another important requirement is fire safety; the project must adhere to the Philippine Fire Code and receive the required fire safety clearances from the Bureau of Fire Protection (BFP). To protect residents and make emergency response easier, the design should include enough fire exits, emergency access, fire protection systems, and safe circulation routes (*HLURB ADMINISTRATIVE ORDER NO. 03, S. 1996, March 05, 1996*, n.d.).

All things considered, these planning guidelines guarantee that mid-rise condominium developments are safe, accessible, compatible with their surroundings, and able to meet the needs of both their occupants and the local community in addition to being effective in terms of land use.

When planning a mid-rise condominium, density and open space requirements are crucial because they help strike a balance between the number of residents that can be accommodated

and the requirements for sufficient outdoor space, natural light, ventilation, and circulation. By preventing excessive site development, these guidelines contribute to the creation of a more comfortable and healthy living environment. Yards, courts, setbacks, driveways, walkways, and shared recreational areas are examples of open spaces that need to be properly planned and maintained. These areas allow for emergency access, landscaping, outdoor activities, and pedestrian mobility. The development's natural lighting and ventilation are further supported by keeping specified open spaces unobstructed from the ground to the sky. The applicable site occupancy and building code requirements govern how much land the building occupies. Reducing the building's footprint guaranties that enough land is left over for landscaping, circulation, open areas, and other crucial site operations. While keeping the development from becoming unduly dense, proper management of building coverage can also enhance access to natural light and ventilation (*Client Challenge*, n.d.-c).

In order to guarantee that private residential development contributes to the greater need for affordable housing, condominium developments are also subject to socialized housing compliance requirements. Subject to the particular requirements and implementing regulations in force, developers may be obliged by applicable housing policies to provide socialized housing equal to at least 5% of the condominium project's area or cost. By encouraging private projects to contribute to housing opportunities for lower-income households, this provision promotes more inclusive housing development.

Overall, density and open space requirements make it possible for mid-rise condominiums to house a sizable population without compromising community spaces, livability, environmental quality, or accessibility. In the Philippine context, where growing urban

density must be balanced with the need for sufficient open spaces and more inclusive housing options, these requirements are especially pertinent.

The License to Sell requirement is an important regulatory measure that protects condominium buyers and ensures that developers meet the necessary standards before offering units to the public. Under the regulations of the Department of Human Settlements and Urban Development (DHSUD), developers are required to register their condominium projects and secure a Certificate of Registration and License to Sell before advertising, marketing, or accepting payments from potential buyers. This process allows the government to review the project's legal, technical, and financial documents and verify that it complies with the required regulations. Through this requirement, the DHSUD helps ensure that condominium projects are legally established and that developers fulfill the necessary conditions before beginning sales activities (*Requirement of License to Sell*, n.d.). Before engaging in sales activities, developers must register their condominium project with the DHSUD and obtain a Certificate of Registration and License to Sell. This helps guarantee that the project is legitimate and that the developer has adhered to the relevant regulations. Documents proving the project's ownership, planning, technical viability, and financial capacity are typically required for the application. These could include approved architectural and engineering plans, building permits, master deeds, financial documents, Transfer Certificates of Title (TCT) or Original Certificates of Title (OCT), and other DHSUD-mandated requirements. These documents' submission and assessment aid in confirming that the planned development can be carried out lawfully and appropriately (Fulgar, 2025).

Developers may also be required to provide a surety or performance bond as financial security for the completion of the project's required infrastructure, facilities, and other

development commitments. This provides buyers with an additional layer of protection by holding developers accountable for fulfilling the responsibilities stated in the approved project plans. Overall, the License to Sell process helps ensure that condominium projects are properly registered, financially and technically supported, and developed in accordance with approved plans before units are offered for sale. It also serves as an important form of government regulation and buyer protection, helping promote accountability and transparency within the condominium industry.

D. Local Zoning Ordinances

The proposed mid-rise condominium development is situated in Muntinlupa City, where the Comprehensive Land Use Plan (CLUP) and local zoning ordinance govern building development and land use. These rules set limits on building height, density, setbacks, and other site development requirements in addition to determining the proper land uses. To guarantee that the proposed condominium is compatible with the neighborhood and does not adversely affect existing residential areas, compliance with these local standards is required. Whether a condominium or other residential development is allowed in the area depends on the site's zoning classification. In addition to being compatible with nearby residential, commercial, institutional, and other developments, the proposed project must be in line with the property's designated land use. When evaluating the project's suitability for higher-density residential use, accessibility and location should also be taken into account. Depending on the site's zoning classification, road width, setbacks, and other development requirements, local zoning regulations may set maximum building heights. These limitations aid in maintaining a mid-rise condominium's

compatibility with the neighborhood and controlling the building's overall scale. Concerns about privacy, natural lighting, ventilation, shadowing, and the development's visual impact on surrounding properties can all be addressed with appropriate building height and massing. The amount of floor space that can be built in relation to the site's overall area is controlled by the Floor Area Ratio. It is a crucial instrument for managing building density and making sure that development doesn't surpass the property's and the surrounding infrastructure's capacity. The site's particular zoning classification and any relevant Muntinlupa City regulations should determine the permitted FAR for the proposed condominium. The project can accommodate a suitable number of residential units while keeping enough space for setbacks, open spaces, landscaping, circulation, parking, and shared amenities thanks to proper FAR management.

Overall, the proposed mid-rise condominium can be developed at a suitable scale, density, and land use intensity with regards to local zoning regulations. By adhering to these specifications, the project can respond to Muntinlupa City's current urban context while offering a secure, practical, and livable residential environment.

E. Environmental Regulations

When planning and developing mid-rise condominiums in Muntinlupa City, environmental regulations play a significant role. In addition to encouraging appropriate waste management, public health, and sustainable resource use, these regulations seek to reduce the negative environmental effects of construction and building operations. Both applicable local city requirements and national environmental regulations must be met by the proposed development.

The proposed condominium may need to obtain an Environmental Compliance Certificate (ECC) from the Department of Environment and Natural Resources (DENR) thru the Environmental Management Bureau (EMB), depending on the project's location, size, and possible environmental impact. The ECC process assesses a development's potential effects on the environment and finds ways to prevent or lessen those effects. Stormwater runoff, drainage, wastewater, flooding, construction impacts, and the preservation of nearby environmental resources are some factors that might be taken into account for a Muntinlupa condominium project. Adherence to the ECC's requirements contributes to ensuring that the project is developed in an environmentally responsible way.

Condominium developments must also manage solid waste properly, adhering to local regulations and the Ecological Solid Waste Management Act (Republic Act No. 9003). Waste segregation, collection, temporary storage, and disposal should all have specific, easily accessible locations within the development. Waste should be appropriately divided into categories, including residual, recyclable, biodegradable, and special waste when appropriate. To avoid offensive smells, pests, and detrimental effects on residential and communal areas, these facilities should be placed strategically and properly screened. Maintaining cleanliness, lowering pollution, and promoting ecologically conscious behavior among locals are all made possible by effective waste management.

Overall, environmental regulations help ensure that the proposed mid-rise condominium is developed with consideration for environmental protection, public health, resource efficiency, and long-term sustainability. These requirements should be incorporated into the planning and architectural design of the project from the early stages of development.

F. Other Regulations

Mid-rise condominium developments in the Philippines must adhere to additional standards that address accessibility, fire safety, building safety, and resident welfare in addition to zoning, environmental, and condominium-specific regulations. These rules contribute to making the development inclusive, safe, and useful for a variety of users. Batas Pambansa Blg should be compliant with the proposed condominium. 344, also known as the Accessibility Law, mandates that structures and facilities give people with disabilities suitable access. The project should include architectural elements like ramps, accessible entrances, elevators, handrails, accessible parking spaces, and well-designed restrooms. These features encourage barrier-free mobility and enable people with various physical abilities to use the building in a safe and self-sufficient manner.

The Philippines' Fire Code (Republic Act No. 9514) and the Bureau of Fire Protection's (BFP) regulations must be followed by mid-rise condominiums. Adequate fire exits, exit routes, fire-resistant construction, emergency lighting, fire detection and alarm systems, fire suppression equipment, and enough access for emergency response vehicles should all be included in the design. To lower fire risks and facilitate a safe evacuation, residential, service, and utility areas should be properly separated.

The development must have suitable systems for managing and maintaining its common areas and facilities after construction and occupancy. Shared areas, utilities, security systems, recreational facilities, and other common property must be properly maintained by the condominium corporation or property management company. Over time, the development's

quality, safety, and functionality can be preserved with clear regulations pertaining to waste management, maintenance fees, facility use, and resident responsibilities.

All things considered, these extra rules guarantee that a mid-rise condominium not only complies with development and planning requirements but also offers its occupants a secure, easily accessible, and well-maintained environment. The building's long-term performance, inclusivity, and functionality can all be enhanced by incorporating these standards early in the architectural planning process.

V. Local Case Studies (Philippines)

A. Serin East



Figure 4. Serin East Tagaytay, Tagaytay City, Cavite.



Figure 5. Serin East Site Development Plan.

1. Project Overview

Serin East Tagaytay is a mid-rise condominium development located in Tagaytay City, Cavite. The project provides residential units within a relatively compact development, offering residents access to shared amenities and landscaped open spaces. The project was developed by Avida Land Corp., a subsidiary of Ayala Land, and is intended to provide residential accommodation within Tagaytay's growing urban and tourism-oriented environment.

Location: Tagaytay City, Cavite

Developer: Avida Land Corp.

Project Type: Mid-rise residential condominium

2. Site Context

Serin East Tagaytay is situated within the urbanized area of Tagaytay City, which is characterized by residential communities, commercial establishments, tourism-related developments, and a cooler highland climate. Its location within an established urban setting allows the development to benefit from existing infrastructure and services rather than functioning as an isolated residential community. The project is accessible through major roads connecting Tagaytay to nearby municipalities, providing residents with convenient access to commercial establishments, schools, healthcare facilities, public transportation, and tourism destinations. The surrounding area consists of a mix of residential, commercial, institutional, and tourism-related land uses, creating an active urban environment while allowing residents to remain close to essential services and recreational areas (Preselling Condo in Tagaytay | Serin East Tagaytay, n.d.).

3. Planning and Design Features

In order to create a well-organized and useful residential environment, Serin East Tagaytay uses a planned layout of residential buildings, parking lots, circulation routes, landscaped areas, and shared amenities. In contrast to high-rise towers, the mid-rise building configuration enables the development to house numerous condominium units while preserving a more human-scale character. Throughout the development, open spaces, landscaped areas, and shared amenities are incorporated to give residents areas for socializing, leisure, and recreation. This configuration makes effective use of the available space while balancing the built-up areas with common areas.

4. Community Design Aspects

Serin East Tagaytay incorporates shared amenities and landscaped areas that serve as communal spaces where residents can gather, relax, and interact outside their individual units, helping encourage social interaction and strengthen the sense of community. The development also provides organized pedestrian and vehicular circulation routes, allowing residents and visitors to move efficiently throughout the site while maintaining separation between pedestrian areas and vehicular movement. Clear connections between entrances, parking areas, residential buildings, and amenities contribute to the overall accessibility, safety, and functionality of the development.

5. Compliance with Regulations

Serin East Tagaytay is subject to various regulations that guide its planning, construction, and operation. The project must comply with the applicable Tagaytay City zoning regulations and Comprehensive Land Use Plan (CLUP), particularly regarding land use, building height, density, setbacks, and other site development controls to ensure compatibility with the surrounding urban environment. As a condominium development, it is also covered by Presidential Decree No. 957 (PD 957), or the Subdivision and Condominium Buyers' Protective Decree, which establishes requirements for project registration, licensing, sales, development obligations, and buyer protection. The project must likewise follow the National Building Code of the Philippines (PD 1096) and its implementing rules, which address building safety, structural design, occupancy, setbacks, light and ventilation, sanitation, accessibility, and other technical requirements. Depending on its classification, location, and potential environmental impacts, the development may also be required to secure an Environmental Compliance Certificate (ECC) from the Department of Environment and Natural Resources (DENR), particularly considering Tagaytay's environmental conditions, landscape, drainage, and

tourism-related setting. In addition, proper solid waste management must be observed in accordance with Republic Act No. 9003, or the Ecological Solid Waste Management Act, including waste segregation, collection, storage, recycling, and proper disposal to maintain a clean and environmentally responsible residential community.

6. Evaluation/Synthesis

Because it can house a sizable number of residential units while maintaining a more manageable building scale than high-rise condominiums, Serin East Tagaytay exemplifies the benefits of employing a mid-rise development approach. Its location offers easy access to businesses, services, and recreational areas, and the incorporation of landscaped areas, shared amenities, and planned circulation contributes to a more community-oriented atmosphere. Its location in a crowded, tourist-heavy area, however, might also exacerbate traffic jams and put more strain on the current infrastructure, such as parking, roads, and utilities. Increased residential density may also make it more difficult to maintain a comfortable living environment, sufficient open spaces, and privacy. All things considered, the case study demonstrates that mid-rise condominiums can successfully strike a balance between housing density, accessibility, community spaces, and the availability of open space without depending on the size of high-rise construction. It also emphasizes how crucial it is to incorporate shared amenities, landscaping, effective transportation, and environmental factors into residential planning while making sure the development stays sensitive to the surrounding urban context and relevant laws.

B. Solmera Coast DMCI



Figure 6. Solmera Coast DMCI, San Juan, Batangas.



Figure 7. Solmera Coast Site Development Plan.

1. Project Overview

Solmera Coast is a mid-rise residential condominium development by DMCI Homes, located in San Juan, Batangas. The project is designed as a resort-inspired residential community that combines condominium living with landscaped outdoor areas, recreational amenities, and spaces that take advantage of its coastal setting. Its mid-rise configuration allows the

development to provide multiple residential units while maintaining a relatively low building profile that complements its natural surroundings (Ods & Ods, 2026).

Location: San Juan, Batangas, Philippines

Developer: DMCI Homes

Project Type: Mid-rise residential condominium

2. Site Context

Solmera Coast is located in San Juan, Batangas, a coastal region well-known for its beaches, resorts, and residential complexes. Because of the project's location, residents can enjoy recreational areas along the coast while still having access to local businesses and nearby roads. Natural landscapes play a significant role in the site's character, and the surrounding environment is typically defined by residential and tourism-related uses. Because of its coastal location, the development's planning and design must take into account factors like climate, sun exposure, prevailing winds, drainage, and environmental protection.

3. Planning and Design Features

To create a residential setting reminiscent of a resort, Solmera Coast employs a planned layout of mid-rise residential buildings, landscaped areas, pedestrian pathways, parking, and recreational amenities. The layout of the buildings enables the project to house several units while keeping a smaller scale that adapts to the coastal environment. The development's integrated open spaces and landscaped areas give residents places to unwind, play, and socialize.

The overall planning strategy places a strong emphasis on the interaction between the residential structures and the surrounding environment.

4. Community Design Aspects

The development includes outdoor gathering places, landscaped areas, and shared recreational facilities to promote social interaction and community involvement. These areas contribute to the project's resort-oriented feel while offering chances for leisure and social interaction. With pathways linking residential buildings to amenities and other common areas, pedestrian and vehicle circulation is planned to facilitate easy mobility throughout the development. A more cohesive residential environment is facilitated by the incorporation of walkable areas and shared amenities (Ods & Ods, 2026).

5. Compliance with Regulations

As a condominium complex in San Juan, Batangas, Solmera Coast must abide by all applicable local zoning laws and land-use policies, which include specifications for site development, building height, density, setbacks, and land use. Presidential Decree No. 957 (PD 957), which establishes rules for condominium developments and safeguards purchasers thru requirements pertaining to project registration, licensing, development obligations, and sales, also applies to the project. In terms of structural safety, occupancy, sanitation, accessibility, light and ventilation, and fire safety, the development must adhere to the National Building Code of the Philippines (PD 1096) and other relevant technical standards. Because of its coastal location, environmental regulations are especially significant. Depending on the project's classification and possible environmental effects, it may be required to obtain an Environmental Compliance Certificate (ECC) and comply with the requirements of the Environmental Impact Assessment

System. According to Republic Act No. 9003, proper solid waste management—which includes waste segregation, collection, storage, recycling, and disposal—should also be put into practice (*DMCI Homes | Real Estate Philippines, Condo, House &Amp; Lot for Sale*, n.d.).

6. Evaluation and Synthesis

The integration of mid-rise residential development with a coastal and resort-oriented environment is one of Solmera Coast's key advantages. Although it can accommodate several housing units, its lower building profile, outdoor spaces, recreational amenities, and landscaped areas create a more laid-back residential setting. However, because of its coastal location, there may be issues with drainage, weather exposure, environmental protection, and long-term maintenance. Additionally, increased development activity may put more strain on the area's natural resources and infrastructure. By incorporating open spaces, recreational areas, and climate-responsive strategies, the project shows how mid-rise condominiums can be designed to adapt to their natural surroundings. When developing housing in coastal areas, the case study emphasizes the significance of striking a balance between residential density, environmental sensitivity, community interaction, and site-specific design considerations.

C. Capri Oasis



Figure 8. Capri Oasis, Maybunga, Pasig City, Metro Manila.



Figure 9. Capri Oasis Site Development Plan.

1. Project Overview

In Maybunga, Pasig City, there is a mid-rise residential condominium complex called Capri Oasis. The project is intended to be a community-focused residential development that includes shared facilities, recreational amenities, landscaped areas, and mid-rise buildings. Its planning strategy makes it possible to accommodate several residential units while preserving common areas and open spaces that promote a cozy and cohesive living environment.

Location: Maybunga, Pasig City, Metro Manila

Developer: Aspire by Filinvest

Project Type: Mid-rise residential condominium

2. Site Context

In Maybunga, Pasig City, there is a mid-rise residential condominium complex called Capri Oasis. The project is intended to be a community-focused residential development that includes shared facilities, recreational amenities, landscaped areas, and mid-rise buildings. Its

planning strategy makes it possible to accommodate several residential units while preserving common areas and open spaces that promote a cozy and cohesive living environment.

3. Planning and Design Features

Mid-rise residential buildings, internal roads, pedestrian walkways, parking lots, landscaped areas, and recreational facilities are all arranged in a planned manner at Capri Oasis. The buildings are set up to maximize the site's potential while maintaining sufficient distance and access to common areas. Its mid-rise layout helps preserve a more human-scale setting by supporting several residential units without producing the scale of a high-rise tower. The development incorporates gardens, landscaped areas, and recreational facilities to give residents places to unwind, play, and socialize. The project's overall livability and sense of community are enhanced by the integration of built and open spaces (*Capri Oasis*, n.d.).

4. Community Design Aspects

Capri Oasis features recreational areas, landscaped areas, and shared amenities that serve as hubs for locals. The development's sense of community is strengthened by these areas, which offer chances for casual conversation, family activities, exercise, and leisure. Residents can move between residential buildings, entrances, parking lots, and amenities thanks to the project's organized pedestrian and vehicular circulation. Maintaining effective movement throughout the site while enhancing safety and comfort is made possible by separating pedestrian pathways from main vehicle routes. A more cohesive and useful residential environment is produced by the combination of shared areas and well-planned circulation.

5. Compliance with Regulations

As a condominium development in Pasig City, Capri Oasis is subject to all applicable local zoning laws and land-use policies, including those pertaining to land use, building height, density, setbacks, parking, and other site development controls. Presidential Decree No. 957 (PD 957), also known as the Subdivision and Condominium Buyers' Protective Decree, governs the project as well. It lays out requirements for project registration, licensing, development obligations, sales, and buyer protection. The National Building Code of the Philippines (PD 1096) and its implementing regulations, which address structural safety, occupancy, sanitation, accessibility, light and ventilation, and other building requirements, must be followed by the development. The Fire Code of the Philippines (RA 9514) and any applicable regulations of the Bureau of Fire Protection must also be complied with by fire and life-safety provisions. In compliance with Republic Act No. 9003, also known as the Ecological Solid Waste Management Act, proper solid waste segregation, collection, storage, and disposal are all essential for an urban residential development. Applicable environmental clearance requirements should also be taken into account, depending on the project's classification and environmental impact (*Capri Oasis*, n.d.).

6. Evaluation and Synthesis

Capri Oasis's use of a mid-rise residential development strategy in conjunction with shared amenities and landscaped open spaces is one of its key advantages. In contrast to high-rise developments, this enables the project to house a sizable number of residents while keeping a more manageable scale. A residential setting that promotes social interaction, leisure, and daily convenience is facilitated by its community facilities and well-organized circulation. However, because of its location in Pasig's densely populated area, it may face difficulties like traffic jams, a lack of open space nearby, issues with drainage and flooding, and a greater demand on the

city's infrastructure. Maintaining privacy, quiet areas, and enough common areas may also be difficult due to the dense population. To conclude, the case study shows how mid-rise condominiums can offer higher-density housing while maintaining landscaped areas, open spaces, community amenities, and pedestrian circulation. It emphasizes how crucial it is to strike a balance in urban residential development between livability, accessibility, safety, and environmental concerns and efficient land use.

VI. Application of the National Building Code of the Philippines (NBCP)

A. Occupancy Classification

According to the National Building Code of the Philippines (PD 1096), Group A, Division A-2, which covers multi-family dwelling units situated in residential condominium buildings or structures regardless of the number of stories, is the applicable occupancy classification for a mid-rise condominium development. Because it sets the proper standards for residential buildings in terms of occupancy, building design, safety, and other technical factors, this classification is pertinent to condominium projects. Additionally, the classification aids in identifying relevant requirements, such as parking regulations and other building standards ("AMENDING TABLE VILA - 1. GROUP a 1.1 DIVISION A-2 OF THE REVISED IMPLEMENTING RULES AND REGULATIONS, P.D. 1096," n.d.).

B. Fire and Life Safety Requirements

Fire and life safety regulations are crucial for a mid-rise condominium in order to safeguard occupants and guarantee their safe evacuation in the event of an emergency. The Fire Code of the Philippines (RA 9514) and its Revised Implementing Rules and Regulations (RIRR),

which outline specifications for exits, means of egress, fire protection systems, and emergency response, are the main laws governing these requirements. According to the BFP's RIRR, buildings must have enough exits and ways out that are suitable for their height, type of construction, number of occupants, and occupancy (“RA 9514 THE FIRE CODE OF THE PHILIPPINES,” n.d.).

The condominium should have unobstructed, clearly marked escape routes, such as exit passageways and stairs in strategic locations. In the event of a fire or other emergency, exits must be clearly marked, well-lit, and positioned to enable residents to get to a secure location. Elevators are regarded as supplemental facilities and are not included in the Fire Code's minimum requirement of two remote exits per floor or fire section for applicable buildings.

To prevent smoke and fire from spreading between apartments and other parts of the building, fire-resistant construction and suitable fire separation should be used. Fire-rated walls and doors, automatic fire alarm and detection systems, fire extinguishers, sprinkler systems, standpipes, emergency lighting, and other fire suppression equipment are some examples of fire protection measures, depending on the building's design and occupancy. To give residents several levels of protection, these systems should be properly maintained and synchronized with the building's evacuation routes. Buildings must be specifically designed and equipped to protect occupants from fire, smoke, vapors, and fumes during evacuation, according to the Fire Code (“RA 9514 THE FIRE CODE OF THE PHILIPPINES,” n.d.).

C. Building Height and Bulk Controls

The National Building Code of the Philippines (PD 1096) governs building height, site occupancy, yards, and other controls for mid-rise condominiums in order to guarantee that the development offers sufficient space, light, ventilation, and safety. The project must adhere to

both the NBCP and the relevant LGU regulations because the local zoning ordinance also affects the specific limits (*PRESIDENTIAL DECREE NO. 1096, February 19, 1977*, n.d.).

The necessary open areas between the building and the property lines are referred to as setbacks. These spaces aid in ensuring that the building has enough light, ventilation, fire separation, and access. The building's occupancy, construction type, height, and site conditions are some of the factors that determine the necessary yards and open spaces under the NBCP. The Code also mandates that buildings have sufficient yards and courts for ventilation and light.

FAR regulates how much floor space can be developed in relation to the lot's size. In order to control the overall intensity of development, it is frequently used in conjunction with building height and other bulk controls. For instance, a building may not always be able to surpass the maximum height or setback requirements even though a higher FAR permits a larger total floor area. Therefore, the site's permitted development controls and local zoning laws are taken into consideration when determining the applicable FAR for a condominium project (*PRESIDENTIAL DECREE NO. 1096, February 19, 1977*, n.d.).

D. Light and Ventilation

The National Building Code of the Philippines (PD 1096), specifically Rule VIII on Light and Ventilation, mandates that residential spaces in mid-rise condominiums have sufficient natural light and ventilation. Because they have an impact on the location and size of windows, building spacing, courts, and other openings that let light and air into livable spaces, these clauses are crucial to condominium design (*PRESIDENTIAL DECREE NO. 1096, February 19, 1977*, n.d.).

Rooms without artificial ventilation must have window openings with a total free area of at least 10% of the room's floor area, according to Section 808 of PD 1096. These windows

should have direct access to an open watercourse, a public street or alley, a court, or a yard. This requirement guaranties adequate daylight and access to fresh air for habitable rooms. Through strategically placed windows, courts, yards, and open areas, the building should be designed to permit natural ventilation. While Section 804 mandates that courts have sufficient dimensions for light and ventilation, with a minimum horizontal dimension of 2.00 meters, Section 805 also stipulates that habitable rooms with natural ventilation must have a minimum ceiling height of 2.70 meters. These specifications can direct how units and building blocks are arranged in condominium developments to avoid overly enclosed or poorly ventilated areas (*PRESIDENTIAL DECREE NO. 1096, February 19, 1977*, n.d.).

These rules can be implemented for a mid-rise condominium by using courts or open areas to increase daylight and natural airflow, appropriately sized windows, appropriate building orientation, and sufficient space between buildings. Because efficient natural ventilation can enhance indoor comfort and possibly lessen reliance on mechanical cooling, this is especially helpful in the climate of the Philippines.

E. Sanitation and Utilities

Sanitation and utility systems are crucial for preserving a functional, safe, and healthy living environment in a mid-rise condominium. Buildings meant for human habitation are required by Section 901 of the National Building Code of the Philippines (PD 1096) to have sufficient plumbing, stormwater drainage, wastewater treatment or disposal systems, potable water, and pest and vermin control measures. Additionally, the Code mandates that sanitary plumbing installations and water pipes adhere to the Philippine National Plumbing Code (*PRESIDENTIAL DECREE NO. 1096, February 19, 1977*, n.d.).

A dependable supply of drinkable water and well-designed plumbing systems for bathrooms, kitchens, toilets, and other fixtures should be provided by the condominium. Sewage and wastewater should be sent to the proper treatment or sewerage system. The building may use an authorized septic or wastewater treatment system in the absence of a public sanitary sewer. Additionally, to avoid contamination and flooding, stormwater and sanitary sewage should be managed independently. The project should include spaces set aside for solid waste collection, temporary storage, segregation, and appropriate disposal. Garbage storage areas should be easily accessible for collection, but they should be kept apart from residential and recreational areas. Additionally, containers should be kept in good condition to avoid odors, pests, and unhygienic conditions. Along with any relevant local laws, solid waste management should adhere to Republic Act No. 9003, also known as the Ecological Solid Waste Management Act. In order to avoid untreated discharge impacting nearby communities and water resources, proper wastewater and sewage treatment is equally important, especially for larger condominium developments (*PRESIDENTIAL DECREE NO. 1096, February 19, 1977*, n.d.).

F. Accessibility

Accessibility should be incorporated into the building and site design of a mid-rise condominium to guarantee that elderly residents, people with disabilities (PWDs), and other users can move around safely and independently. Pambansa Blg. Batas. 344 (BP 344), also known as the Accessibility Law, mandates suitable structural and architectural elements, such as accessible sidewalks, ramps, railings, and designated parking spaces, that enhance the mobility of people with disabilities (*BATAS PAMBANSA BLG. 344, February 25, 1983*, n.d.).

Parking lots, entrances, lobbies, elevators, residential areas, amenities, and other frequently used spaces should all be connected by a continuous, unhindered accessible route.

Users with mobility limitations should be able to access different floors via elevators or other suitable vertical-access systems, and ramps should be installed where floor levels change. Arrival and departure areas should be connected to accessible entrances, and doors along accessible routes should be wide enough to accommodate wheelchair users. Additionally, the location should have barrier-free pathways, accessible restrooms, accessible ramps, handrails, suitable signage, and designated parking spaces for people with disabilities. These features encourage a more inclusive residential environment and enable the condominium to accommodate users with varying physical abilities. Therefore, rather than being added only after construction, compliance with BP 344 should be taken into account from the site-planning stage through detailed building design (*BATAS PAMBANSA BLG. 344, February 25, 1983*, n.d.).

G. Application to Mid-Rise Developments

With careful planning of the building, site, and shared facilities, mid-rise condominium developments can directly comply with the National Building Code of the Philippines (PD 1096) and related regulations. These specifications aid in maintaining the development's safety, accessibility, comfort, and suitability for the intended residential use (“Amendment on the Implementing Rules and Regulations of BP 344,” n.d.).

The necessary setbacks, building height, floor area, exits and egress routes, fire protection systems, natural lighting and ventilation, sanitary facilities, and accessible routes can all be included in the early planning stages to achieve design compliance. Additionally, barrier-free entrances, ramps, accessible parking, elevators, and other amenities that enable people with disabilities to move freely throughout the development should be incorporated into BP 344. Because required setbacks, open spaces, circulation areas, fire exits, and accessibility provisions take up important areas of the site, applying these regulations can make it difficult to maximize

the number of units and usable floor area. As a result, developers must strike a balance between livability, safety, accessibility, comfort, and profitability. Construction and maintenance costs may also rise due to additional requirements like parking, waste facilities, elevators, fire protection systems, and environmental measures. However, rather than concentrating solely on increasing the number of units, these limitations help guarantee that mid-rise developments offer residents a safer and more functional environment ("Amendment on the Implementing Rules and Regulations of BP 344," n.d.).

VII. Synthesis and Analysis

Mid-rise condominiums can offer a workable solution for higher-density housing while preserving livability and community interaction, according to a review of pertinent literature, laws, and case studies. While PD 957 offers regulatory protection for condominium buyers and specifies requirements for project development and delivery, the National Building Code of the Philippines (PD 1096) sets requirements for building safety, occupancy, light and ventilation, sanitation, and other technical considerations (*Presidential Decree No. 1096, S. 1977*, n.d.). DHSUD also regulates condominium developments and requires projects to be registered and licensed before they can be advertised or sold (*Republic Act 11201*, n.d.).

In mid-rise residential developments, the literature highlights the significance of human-scale design, sufficient open spaces, accessibility, natural ventilation, community facilities, and effective land use. Regulations in the Philippines that set minimum requirements for building performance, safety, accessibility, sanitation, and fire safety support these ideas. The case studies of Serin East Tagaytay, Solmera Coast, and Capri Oasis show how these ideas can

be implemented in various settings, especially when it comes to the incorporation of shared amenities, organized circulation, landscaped areas, and mid-rise building configurations.

A number of best practices, such as effective site planning, the incorporation of open and green spaces, clear pedestrian and vehicle circulation, accessible facilities, sufficient natural lighting and ventilation, and well-placed community amenities, can be found in the projects that were reviewed. Additionally, mid-rise structures should adapt to their unique environments, such as the dense urban setting of Capri Oasis or the coastal environment of Solmera Coast. These strategies enable developments to house more people without compromising social interaction opportunities, safety, comfort, or environmental quality.

Efficient yet livable unit layouts, sufficient setbacks and open spaces, natural ventilation and daylighting, barrier-free circulation, fire-safe egress, and accessible community facilities should be given top priority in the design of upcoming mid-rise condominium projects. Instead of treating open space as leftover areas, the site should incorporate green spaces, shaded pedestrian pathways, landscaped courtyards, and multipurpose communal areas. While parking, waste management, utilities, and service areas should be planned without sacrificing pedestrian safety or the standard of public spaces, building orientation should also take into account the local climate. Rather than being addressed only during permitting, compliance with NBCP, PD 957, BP 344, Fire Code requirements, environmental regulations, and local zoning should be taken into account from the start of the design process.

All things considered, mid-rise condominiums are important for community architecture and urban planning because they can meet rising housing demand while fostering social interaction and shared living. Successful mid-rise developments should balance density, privacy, accessibility, open space, sustainability, and community life rather than just maximizing the

number of units. The case studies demonstrate that the building's relationship with its occupants and the surrounding urban environment is just as significant as the building's overall efficiency. As a result, mid-rise condominium design ought to be viewed as a type of community development in which architecture helps create safe, inclusive, connected, and sustainable neighborhoods in addition to housing.

VIII. Conclusion

The study shows that mid-rise condominiums can be an effective approach to addressing the growing demand for housing in the Philippines while maintaining a balance between density and livability. The review of literature, regulations, and case studies shows that successful developments should integrate efficient land use, adequate open spaces, natural lighting and ventilation, accessibility, fire safety, community amenities, and organized circulation. Philippine regulations such as PD 1096, PD 957, BP 344, and the Fire Code provide important standards that guide the safety, functionality, and quality of condominium developments.

The results highlight the need for architectural design to do more than just maximize the quantity of residential units. From the outset of the design process, human-scale planning, greenery, pedestrian connectivity, community spaces, climate-responsive design, and accessible facilities should be included. The case studies also show how crucial the surrounding context is, requiring architects to take into account elements like existing infrastructure, accessibility, urban density, and environmental conditions. Rather than being viewed as merely a permitting requirement, regulatory compliance should be incorporated into the design process.

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